

How Young People Manage Stress and Everyday Challenges

Welcome! Ready to help design something genuinely useful? 🚀

Most wellbeing apps expect you to journal, meditate, or pour out your feelings. But what if that's just not your style?

I want to know how you really handle everyday pressure and stress. As part of my MSc in User Experience and Service Design at Loughborough University, I am researching how young people stay motivated so we can build a new kind of digital tool for young men. We aren't looking at passive solutions; we want to design something practical, action-orientated, and useful.

While we are designing this with young men in mind, we want to hear perspectives from people of all genders. There are no right or wrong answers, and your input will directly shape what gets built!

The Details:

- 🕒 Time: Just 7-10 minutes of your time.
- 🔒 Privacy: Completely anonymous and confidential.

Before we begin, by clicking 'Next', you confirm that:

1. You are aged 18 years or older.
2. You have read the study information.
3. You voluntarily agree to participate.

Data Protection Statement

This research complies with the UK General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR) and Loughborough University's research ethics requirements.

- Your participation is voluntary.
- No personally identifying information will be collected unless you choose to provide your email address for future participation.
- Any email address provided will be stored separately from your survey responses.
- Survey responses will only be used for academic research.
- Data will be securely stored on password-protected university systems.
- Only the researcher and academic supervisor will have access to the research data.
- Anonymous data may be retained in accordance with university policy.

Section A – About You

1. Which of the following best describes your gender?

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- ☐ Male
- ☐ Female
- ☐ Non binary
- ☐ Prefer not to say
- ☐ Other (please specify)

2. What is your age?

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- ☐ 18–21
- ☐ 22–25
- ☐ 26–30
- ☐ 31–35
- ☐ 36 or above

3. What is your ethnic background?

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- ☐ Black / African
- ☐ East Asian
- ☐ Hispanic / Latino
- ☐ Middle Eastern
- ☐ Mixed / Multiple ethnic groups
- ☐ South Asian
- ☐ Southeast Asian
- ☐ White
- ☐ Prefer not to say
- ☐ Other (please specify)

4. Which country do you currently reside in?

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- ☐ United Kingdom
- ☐ India
- ☐ Other (please specify)

5. Which best describes your current situation?

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- ☐ University student (full-time)
- ☐ University student (part-time)
- ☐ Employed full-time
- ☐ Employed part-time
- ☐ Apprentice / vocational training
- ☐ Unemployed
- ☐ Other (please specify)

Section B – How You Deal with Stress

6. How often do you feel under noticeable pressure or stress?

*

- ☐ Rarely (once a month or less)
- ☐ Occasionally (a few times a month)
- ☐ Often (several times a week)
- ☐ Almost every day

7. In a typical week, how much time do you intentionally spend on activities that support your mental wellbeing?

*

- ☐ Less than 30 minutes
- ☐ 30 minutes–1 hour
- ☐ 1–3 hours
- ☐ 3–5 hours
- ☐ More than 5 hours
- ☐ I'm not sure

8. How often do the following contribute to your stress?

*

Work or University

- ☐ Never
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Often
- ☐ Very often

Money or Finances

- ☐ Never
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Often
- ☐ Very often

Romantic or Family relationships

- ☐ Never
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Often
- ☐ Very often

Health or Physical wellbeing

- ☐ Never
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Often
- ☐ Very often

Uncertainty about the future

- ☐ Never
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Often
- ☐ Very often

9. Are you usually aware when your stress is gradually building up?

- ☐ Yes, usually
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ No

10. How confident are you in managing stress on your own?

*



11. When you first notice you're stressed, what do you usually do? *(Select all that apply)*

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- ☐ Exercise or go to the gym

- ☐ Play video games
- ☐ Listen to music or a podcast
- ☐ Scroll through social media
- ☐ Go for a walk or spend time outdoors
- ☐ Watch TV or films
- ☐ Meet up with friends
- ☐ Work on a hobby or personal project
- ☐ Try to sleep
- ☐ Keep busy and push through
- ☐ Other (please specify)

12. When stress continues for several days, what do you usually do? *(Select all that apply)*

- ☐ Keep going and hope it passes
- ☐ Exercise or do something physical
- ☐ Distract myself with something enjoyable
- ☐ Talk to a friend or family member
- ☐ Search online for information or advice
- ☐ Use a wellbeing or self-help app
- ☐ I usually do not realise it is building up until it becomes overwhelming
- ☐ Try to address the problem causing you stress
- ☐ Other (please specify)

13. Please indicate how much you agree.

*

I prefer solving problems on my own

- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Agree

I avoid talking about my stress

- ☐ Disagree

- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Agree

I usually look for practical solutions

- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Agree

I continue working despite feeling stressed

- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Agree

I find it difficult to ask for help

- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Agree

14. If you experienced significant stress tomorrow, how likely would you be to...

*

Talk to a friend

- ☐ Unlikely
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Likely

Talk to a family member

- ☐ Unlikely
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Likely

Search online for information or advice

- ☐ Unlikely
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Likely

Use an AI chatbot (e.g., ChatGPT) for advice or support

- ☐ Unlikely
- ☐ Neutral

☐ Likely

Use a wellbeing or mental health app

☐ Unlikely

☐ Neutral

☐ Likely

Speak to a counsellor

☐ Unlikely

☐ Neutral

☐ Likely

Do nothing and wait for it to pass

☐ Unlikely

☐ Neutral

☐ Likely

Section C – Digital Wellbeing Tools

15. Have you ever used a wellbeing or mental health app?

*

- ☐ Yes, I currently use one
- ☐ Yes, but I stopped using it
- ☐ No, but I have considered it
- ☐ No, and I have never considered using one

16. Which wellbeing or mental health app(s) have you used or considered?

*

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17. What did you like or dislike about the app(s)

*

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18. If you stopped using a wellbeing app or chose not to use one, why? *(Select all that apply)*

*

- ☐ It did not feel relevant to me
- ☐ The design did not appeal to me
- ☐ It focused too much on talking about feelings
- ☐ I was concerned about privacy
- ☐ It felt too much like therapy
- ☐ It became repetitive
- ☐ I forgot to use it

- ☐ It was too expensive
- ☐ I did not think it would help
- ☐ I did not want others to see it on my phone
- ☐ Other (please specify)

19. If you could not easily talk to someone about a stressful situation, what would you most likely do instead?

- ☐ Search online for advice
- ☐ Use a practical digital tool or app
- ☐ Distract myself until it passes
- ☐ Keep working and push through
- ☐ Nothing in particular
- ☐ Other (please specify)

20. How important are the following features in a well-being app?

Lowest rating: 1 and Highest rating: 5

*

Quick activities (<2 min)

- ☐ 1
- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ 4
- ☐ 5

Anonymous use

- ☐ 1
- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ 4
- ☐ 5

Practical stress-management advice/solutions

- ☐ 1

- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ 4
- ☐ 5

Personalised recommendations

- ☐ 1
- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ 4
- ☐ 5

Mood and stress tracking

- ☐ 1
- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ 4
- ☐ 5

Progress tracking

- ☐ 1
- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ 4
- ☐ 5

Interactive exercises/scenarios

- ☐ 1
- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ 4
- ☐ 5

Gamification (Goals, challenges, and rewards)

- ☐ 1
- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ 4
- ☐ 5

Activity-based wellbeing (walking, running, hobbies, etc.)

- ☐ 1
- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ 4
- ☐ 5

Community/social connection

- ☐ 1
- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ 4
- ☐ 5

Health app integration (Apple Health, Strava, etc.)

- ☐ 1
- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ 4
- ☐ 5

Educational content about stress, emotions, and wellbeing

- ☐ 1
- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ 4
- ☐ 5

Simple, non-clinical design

- ☐ 1
- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ 4
- ☐ 5

21. Please indicate your agreement.

I would avoid an app that obviously looks like a mental health app.

- ☐ Disagree

- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Agree

I prefer practical advice over emotional support

- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Agree

Privacy is very important to me

- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Agree

I would use an app more if it felt like a productivity or fitness app

- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Agree

I would trust an app that explains how my data is used

- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Agree

Section D – Your Thoughts

This is an optional section.

22. Thinking about a difficult period during the past year (for example, related to work, study, relationships, or finances), what helped you keep going?
There is no right answer. This could be an activity, a routine, a habit, a tool, or just how you approached it. Please avoid including personal or identifying information.

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23. Imagine an app designed specifically to help young men manage everyday pressure using practical, action-based activities rather than therapy or journaling. What features would make you want to use it regularly? Is there anything you would improve or change?
Be as specific or as general as you like. Your answer will directly shape what gets built.

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24. If this app were available today, how likely would you be to recommend it to a friend experiencing stress?



0 5
Not at all likely Extremely likely

Section E – Future Participation (Optional)

25. Would you be willing to take part in a follow-up interview or help test early design concepts for this research?

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☐ Yes

☐ No

26. Please provide your email address if you would like to be contacted about future stages of this research.

Your email address will be stored separately from your survey responses to maintain your anonymity.

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Researcher Contact Information

If you have any questions about this study or would like further information, please feel free to contact me:

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